Pullbacks. A pullback happens almost two-thirds of the time. That's about the rate we see for both throwbacks and pullbacks, oddly enough, and that's reassuring (only pullbacks apply to double tops, so don't let me confuse the issue with facts).

It does not take long for the stock to return to the breakout price—11 days on average. When a pullback does occur, it hurts performance, as the table shows. I think that's because the upward curl of a pullback robs downward momentum, eventually hurting overall performance. Don't quote me on that because it's only a guess.

After a pullback completes, price continues to drop 54% of the time.

Gaps. A breakout day gap does give better performance, on average, but not so you'd notice. However, the gap size is painful compared to some other bearish chart patterns with gaps.

[Table 30.5](#) shows pattern size statistics.

Height. Tall patterns perform better than short ones, and the difference for a bearish pattern is surprisingly wide. And that's coming from an author who abhors adverbs.

I determined height from the highest peak in the pattern to the lowest valley between the two peaks. I divided the height by the price of the lowest valley. The results, for all Adam & Adam double tops measured this way, I show as the median in the table. A value above the median means the double top is tall.

Width. Wide patterns perform better than do narrow ones, but the performance difference isn't big. I used the median width as the separator between narrow and wide.

Height and width combinations. The table shows the performance results when combining the height and width traits. Patterns that are both tall and narrow perform best by seeing price decline most after the breakout. The table also shows that you should avoid short double tops.

[Table 30.6](#) shows volume-related statistics.

Volume trend. I used linear regression to determine the volume trend. I found it recedes as measured from the left peak to the right one. However,